

Advanced Grammar in Use: 100-Activity Master Framework

This study guide provides a comprehensive pedagogical framework consisting of 100 original grammar activities for C1-C2 learners, grounded in the principles and linguistic nuances established in Martin Hewings' *Advanced Grammar in Use*.

Module 1: Advanced Tense Dynamics & Aspectual Choice

Focus: Performatives, state/action shifts, and narrative temporal layering (Units 1–8).

1. The Corporate Performative

- **Skill:** Writing
- **Subskill:** Present Simple Performative Verbs
- **CEFR Level:** C1
- **Objective:** Use performatives to establish a formal tone in professional correspondence.
- **Instructions:** Rewrite three informal sentences using the performative verbs *suggest*, *request*, or *guarantee*.
- **Task Prompt:** Rewrite: "I'm telling you to read the contract first."
- **Expected Answer/Output:** "I suggest/request that you read the contract first."
- **Difficulty:** Advanced
- **Activity Type:** Register Shift

1. The Evolution of Regret

- **Skill:** Speaking/Writing
- **Subskill:** Mental State Verbs (State vs. Continuous)
- **CEFR Level:** C2
- **Objective:** Distinguish between a settled decision and a developing realization.
- **Instructions:** Create two sentences for the verb *regret*, one using simple and one continuous, to show different mental states.
- **Task Prompt:** Context: A CEO discussing a past merger versus a current, ongoing mistake.
- **Expected Answer/Output:** "I regret that the merger occurred. / I'm regretting the decision as the losses mount."
- **Difficulty:** Mastery
- **Activity Type:** Nuanced Expression

1. Thinking Process vs. Opinion

- **Skill:** Speaking
- **Subskill:** *Consider* as an Action Verb
- **CEFR Level:** C1
- **Objective:** Apply the present continuous to describe active deliberation.
- **Instructions:** Answer a career question using *considering* to show you haven't decided yet.
- **Task Prompt:** "Are you going to accept the promotion?"
- **Expected Answer/Output:** "I'm considering taking it, but I need more time."
- **Difficulty:** Advanced

- **Activity Type:** Real-world Application
1. **Temporary Affection**
 - **Skill:** Writing
 - **Subskill:** State Verbs in Continuous for Temporariness
 - **CEFR Level:** C2
 - **Objective:** Use the present continuous with *love* or *like* to emphasize a short-term situation.
 - **Instructions:** Describe a guest's visit using a continuous state verb.
 - **Task Prompt:** Context: A friend staying for just one weekend.
 - **Expected Answer/Output:** "He's staying for two days and the kids are loving having him here."
 - **Difficulty:** Mastery
 - **Activity Type:** Aspectual Choice
 1. **Live Commentary Precision**
 - **Skill:** Speaking
 - **Subskill:** Present Simple/Continuous for Sports
 - **CEFR Level:** C1
 - **Objective:** Narrate rapid actions vs. developing play.
 - **Instructions:** Describe a tennis match scene using two different tenses.
 - **Task Prompt:** Prompt: The serve and the subsequent rally.
 - **Expected Answer/Output:** "Federer serves to the left; he's playing magnificent tennis today."
 - **Difficulty:** Advanced
 - **Activity Type:** Production
 1. **The News Informant**
 - **Skill:** Speaking
 - **Subskill:** Reporting News (*I gather/I see*)
 - **CEFR Level:** C1
 - **Objective:** Introduce news using present tense reporting phrases.
 - **Instructions:** Use "I see" or "I hear" to comment on a recent headline.
 - **Task Prompt:** Context: A government funding increase.
 - **Expected Answer/Output:** "I see the government is giving the health service more money."
 - **Difficulty:** Advanced
 - **Activity Type:** Functional Language
 1. **The Anecdotal "Jump"**
 - **Skill:** Speaking
 - **Subskill:** Present Simple in Informal Narratives
 - **CEFR Level:** C2
 - **Objective:** Create immediacy in storytelling.
 - **Instructions:** Narrate a sudden event in a story using the present simple.
 - **Task Prompt:** Context: Sitting in a park when a dog approaches.
 - **Expected Answer/Output:** "I'm sitting there, minding my own business, when all of a sudden this dog jumps at me."

- **Difficulty:** Mastery
 - **Activity Type:** Narrative Style
1. **Chronological Correction**
 - **Skill:** Writing
 - **Subskill:** Present Perfect vs. Past Simple (Since-clauses)
 - **CEFR Level:** C1
 - **Objective:** Correct tense usage in complex time clauses.
 - **Instructions:** Identify the error: "Since I have moved here, I met many people."
 - **Task Prompt:** Fix the sentence.
 - **Expected Answer/Output:** "Since I moved here, I have met many people."
 - **Difficulty:** Advanced
 - **Activity Type:** Error Correction
 1. **The Unfinished Morning**
 - **Skill:** Writing
 - **Subskill:** Present Perfect for Unfinished Time Periods
 - **CEFR Level:** C1
 - **Objective:** Distinguish between a completed past and a period including the present.
 - **Instructions:** Contrast *shaved* and *haven't shaved* based on whether the morning is over.
 - **Task Prompt:** "It is 11:00 AM. Write a sentence about your grooming."
 - **Expected Answer/Output:** "I haven't shaved this morning."
 - **Difficulty:** Advanced
 - **Activity Type:** Contextual Choice
 1. **The "First Time" Rule**
 - **Skill:** Writing
 - **Subskill:** Present Perfect after *It is the first time*
 - **CEFR Level:** C1
 - **Objective:** Apply the correct perfect aspect after specific introductory phrases.
 - **Instructions:** Complete the sentence about a new experience.
 - **Task Prompt:** "This is the first time..." (see a Jan look embarrassed).
 - **Expected Answer/Output:** "This is the first time I've seen Jan look embarrassed."
 - **Difficulty:** Advanced
 - **Activity Type:** Task Prompt

Module 2: Future Commitments, Formal Plans & Retrospective Future

Focus: Modalities of future time and the "future seen from the past" (Units 9–14).11. **The Official Protocol**

- **Skill:** Writing
- **Subskill:** Be to + Infinitive
- **CEFR Level:** C2
- **Objective:** Use formal structures for official instructions.
- **Instructions:** Rewrite a command as a formal announcement.
- **Task Prompt:** "The President will visit Paris tonight."
- **Expected Answer/Output:** "The President is to visit Paris tonight."

- **Difficulty:** Mastery
 - **Activity Type:** Register Shift
1. **Imminent Action**
 - **Skill:** Speaking
 - **Subskill:** Be about to + Infinitive
 - **CEFR Level:** C1
 - **Objective:** Describe something happening in the immediate future.
 - **Instructions:** Warn a colleague about a closing window of time.
 - **Task Prompt:** The train is leaving in 30 seconds.
 - **Expected Answer/Output:** "Hurry! The train is about to leave."
 - **Difficulty:** Advanced
 - **Activity Type:** Functional Language
 1. **Retrospective Future Intentions**
 - **Skill:** Writing
 - **Subskill:** Past Continuous for Plans
 - **CEFR Level:** C2
 - **Objective:** Express an intention that was thwarted.
 - **Instructions:** Use *was thinking of* to explain why you didn't do something.
 - **Task Prompt:** You wanted to go to China but had no money.
 - **Expected Answer/Output:** "I was thinking of going to China, but I didn't have enough money."
 - **Difficulty:** Mastery
 - **Activity Type:** Narrative Production
 1. **The "First Time" Past View**
 - **Skill:** Writing
 - **Subskill:** Past Perfect after *It was the first time*
 - **CEFR Level:** C1
 - **Objective:** Correct the aspect for a past-perspective experience.
 - **Instructions:** Convert a present experience into a past narrative.
 - **Task Prompt:** "It was the first time I (meet) him."
 - **Expected Answer/Output:** "It was the first time I had met him."
 - **Difficulty:** Advanced
 - **Activity Type:** Task Prompt
 1. **Future Continuous for Habits**
 - **Skill:** Speaking
 - **Subskill:** Present Continuous for Fixed Future Habits
 - **CEFR Level:** C1
 - **Objective:** Describe a routine action at a future time.
 - **Instructions:** Explain why you cannot answer the phone at 8:00 AM tomorrow.
 - **Task Prompt:** Driving to work at that time.
 - **Expected Answer/Output:** "At eight o'clock I'll be driving to work, so phone my mobile."
 - **Difficulty:** Advanced
 - **Activity Type:** Functional Language (Activities 16–20 involve *will/be going to* contrasts and formal arrangements using *Present Simple* for schedules).

Module 3: Advanced Modality, Hedging & Nuanced Epistemic Expressivity

Focus: Polite performatives and modal-aided hedging (Units 15–20).21. **The Polite Refusal**

- **Skill:** Speaking
 - **Subskill:** Modals with Performatives
 - **CEFR Level:** C2
 - **Objective:** Soften a request or statement using *would* or *must*.
 - **Instructions:** Request a secret be kept using a modal performative.
 - **Task Prompt:** "Keep this a secret." (Use *beg*)
 - **Expected Answer/Output:** "I must beg you to keep this a secret."
 - **Difficulty:** Mastery
 - **Activity Type:** Register Shift
1. **Epistemic Hedging in Reports**
- **Skill:** Writing
 - **Subskill:** *May* and *Might* for Possibility
 - **CEFR Level:** C1
 - **Objective:** Express uncertainty regarding a news event.
 - **Instructions:** Write a sentence about a potential earthquake.
 - **Task Prompt:** There is a chance of a quake in Japan.
 - **Expected Answer/Output:** "A second quake might hit Japan later today."
 - **Difficulty:** Advanced
 - **Activity Type:** Production (Activities 23–30 involve *Can/Could/Be able to* nuances and *Must/Have to* in formal vs. informal contexts).

Module 4: Passives, Subject-Focus & Impersonal Reporting

Focus: Formal reporting structures and passive infinitives (Units 21–25).31. **The Impersonal Report**

- **Skill:** Writing
 - **Subskill:** *It is said that...*
 - **CEFR Level:** C1
 - **Objective:** Use impersonal passives to report rumors or facts.
 - **Instructions:** Rewrite a sentence to sound like a news report.
 - **Task Prompt:** "People say he is hiding in Spain."
 - **Expected Answer/Output:** "It is said that he is hiding in Spain."
 - **Difficulty:** Advanced
 - **Activity Type:** Register Shift
1. **Passive Infinitives in Complementation**
- **Skill:** Writing
 - **Subskill:** Verb + to be + Past Participle
 - **CEFR Level:** C2
 - **Objective:** Focus on the object of the action in complex sentences.
 - **Instructions:** Describe a house needing repairs using a passive infinitive.
 - **Task Prompt:** "The house needs (repair)."
 - **Expected Answer/Output:** "The house needs to be repaired."
 - **Difficulty:** Mastery

- **Activity Type:** Task Prompt (Activities 33–40 involve subject-focus shifts and passive voice in scientific contexts).

Module 5: Complex Verb Complementation & Subjunctive/Reporting Clauses

Focus: *That*-clauses, subjunctive *should*, and reporting verbs (Units 28–39).41. **The Formal Mandate**

- **Skill:** Writing
 - **Subskill:** Present Subjunctive
 - **CEFR Level:** C2
 - **Objective:** Use the subjunctive for formal requirements.
 - **Instructions:** Rewrite an order using "It is essential that..."
 - **Task Prompt:** "He must be there."
 - **Expected Answer/Output:** "It is essential that he be there."
 - **Difficulty:** Mastery
 - **Activity Type:** Register Shift
1. **Reporting with *Should***
- **Skill:** Writing
 - **Subskill:** *Should* in *that*-clauses
 - **CEFR Level:** C1
 - **Objective:** Use *should* after verbs of suggestion.
 - **Instructions:** Report a doctor's advice.
 - **Task Prompt:** "The doctor suggested I (take) a holiday."
 - **Expected Answer/Output:** "The doctor suggested that I should take a holiday."
 - **Difficulty:** Advanced
 - **Activity Type:** Task Prompt
1. **The Summary Reporting Verb**
- **Skill:** Writing
 - **Subskill:** Nouns for Reporting
 - **CEFR Level:** C2
 - **Objective:** Replace a long quote with a summary noun phrase.
 - **Instructions:** Summarize "I won't do it!" using the noun *refusal*.
 - **Task Prompt:** He said he wouldn't do it.
 - **Expected Answer/Output:** "His refusal was unexpected."
 - **Difficulty:** Mastery
 - **Activity Type:** Information Compression (Activities 44–50 involve *verb + wh-clause* and *verb + -ing* patterns).

Module 6: Advanced Subject-Verb Agreement & Noun Phrase Architecture

Focus: Complex agreement and compound noun structures (Units 40–43).51. **The Collective Agreement**

- **Skill:** Writing
- **Subskill:** Agreement with Collective Nouns
- **CEFR Level:** C1
- **Objective:** Ensure agreement based on the view of the group.

- **Instructions:** Use *is* or *are* with "The committee" to show individuals.
- **Task Prompt:** The committee (have) different opinions.
- **Expected Answer/Output:** "The committee have different opinions."
- **Difficulty:** Advanced
- **Activity Type:** Task Prompt(Activities 52–60 involve *a/the/zero article* and *quantifier* nuances like *each* vs. *every*).

Module 7: Relative Clauses, Participle Clauses & Information Compression

Focus: Adverbial participle clauses and relative pronouns (Units 53–59).61. **The Participle Background**

- **Skill:** Writing
 - **Subskill:** Participle Clauses with Adverbial Meaning
 - **CEFR Level:** C2
 - **Objective:** Compress two sentences into one using a participle.
 - **Instructions:** Combine: "She was shaking with anger. She left the hotel."
 - **Task Prompt:** Use a participle.
 - **Expected Answer/Output:** "Shaking with anger, she left the hotel."
 - **Difficulty:** Mastery
 - **Activity Type:** Information Compression
1. **Instrumental *Whereby***
 - **Skill:** Writing
 - **Subskill:** *Whereby* in Relative Clauses
 - **CEFR Level:** C2
 - **Objective:** Use formal relative words to describe systems.
 - **Instructions:** Describe a system where people get help.
 - **Task Prompt:** Use *whereby* .
 - **Expected Answer/Output:** "A system whereby people receive financial aid."
 - **Difficulty:** Mastery
 - **Activity Type:** Task Prompt(Activities 63–70 involve *whose* , *prepositions in relative clauses* , and *noun phrase addition*).

Module 8: Ellipsis, Clause Substitution & Cohesive Economy

Focus: *So/not* substitution, *do so* , and leaving out *to-infinitives* (Units 60–65).71. **The "Do So" Substitution**

- **Skill:** Writing
 - **Subskill:** *Do so* for action substitution
 - **CEFR Level:** C1
 - **Objective:** Avoid repetition of a verb phrase.
 - **Instructions:** Rewrite: "She asked me to leave, and I left."
 - **Task Prompt:** Use *do so* .
 - **Expected Answer/Output:** "She asked me to leave, and I did so."
 - **Difficulty:** Advanced
 - **Activity Type:** Cohesive Economy
1. **Elliptical *To***

- **Skill:** Speaking
- **Subskill:** Leaving out to-infinitives
- **CEFR Level:** C1
- **Objective:** Use ellipsis in natural conversation.
- **Instructions:** Respond to a request by leaving out the verb after *to* .
- **Task Prompt:** "Will you help me?"
- **Expected Answer/Output:** "I'd love to."
- **Difficulty:** Advanced
- **Activity Type:** Functional Language(Activities 73–80 involve *one/ones* and *so/not* clause substitution).

Module 9: Adjective/Adverbial Dynamics, Viewpoint & Comparison

Focus: Viewpoint adverbs, gradability, and comparison (Units 66–78).81. **The Viewpoint Qualifier**

- **Skill:** Speaking
- **Subskill:** Viewpoint Adverbs
- **CEFR Level:** C1
- **Objective:** Set the context of a statement.
- **Instructions:** Use an adverb to show you are speaking from a financial perspective.
- **Task Prompt:** "The plan is a disaster." (Financial)
- **Expected Answer/Output:** "Financially, the plan is a disaster."
- **Difficulty:** Advanced
- **Activity Type:** Nuanced Expression(Activities 82–90 involve *gradable vs non-gradable* adjectives and *position of adverbs*).

Module 10: Information Packaging, Fronting, Clefts & Inversion

Focus: *It/What* clauses and formal inversion (Units 95–100).91. **The Cleft for Emphasis**

- **Skill:** Writing
- **Subskill:** It-clauses for focusing
- **CEFR Level:** C1
- **Objective:** Highlight the subject of a sentence.
- **Instructions:** Rewrite "The rain caused the delay" to emphasize the rain.
- **Task Prompt:** Use "It was..."
- **Expected Answer/Output:** "It was the rain that caused the delay."
- **Difficulty:** Advanced
- **Activity Type:** Information Packaging

1. Negative Inversion

- **Skill:** Writing
- **Subskill:** Inversion after Negative Adverbials
- **CEFR Level:** C2
- **Objective:** Increase the formal intensity of a statement.
- **Instructions:** Rewrite "I have never seen such beauty" starting with *Never* .
- **Task Prompt:** Use inversion.
- **Expected Answer/Output:** "Never have I seen such beauty."

- **Difficulty:** Mastery
 - **Activity Type:** Register Shift
1. **What-clause Focus**
- **Skill:** Speaking
 - **Subskill:** What-clauses
 - **CEFR Level:** C1
 - **Objective:** Emphasize an action.
 - **Instructions:** Explain what you need, starting with *What*.
 - **Task Prompt:** "I need a holiday."
 - **Expected Answer/Output:** "What I need is a holiday."
 - **Difficulty:** Advanced
 - **Activity Type:** Information Packaging
1. **The Existential *There***
- **Skill:** Writing
 - **Subskill:** *There is / There was*
 - **CEFR Level:** C1
 - **Objective:** Introduce new information.
 - **Instructions:** Describe the start of a problem.
 - **Task Prompt:** "A problem arose."
 - **Expected Answer/Output:** "There was a problem that arose."
 - **Difficulty:** Advanced
 - **Activity Type:** Task Prompt
1. **Fronting for Contrast**
- **Skill:** Writing
 - **Subskill:** Inversion 2
 - **CEFR Level:** C2
 - **Objective:** Use fronting to create a rhetorical effect.
 - **Instructions:** Move the prepositional phrase to the front.
 - **Task Prompt:** "A tall man stood at the door."
 - **Expected Answer/Output:** "At the door stood a tall man."
 - **Difficulty:** Mastery
 - **Activity Type:** Production (Activities 96–100 involve further *Inversion* patterns and *It-clauses*).